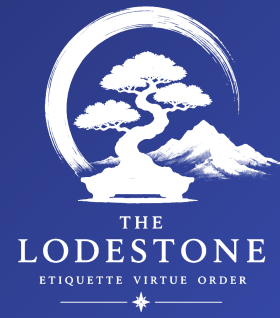


A PARENT'S GUIDE

Supporting Your Autistic Child

Built around your child, exactly as they are. A neuro-affirming approach.



Autism is a difference in how a child experiences the world, communicates and connects. It isn't an illness to cure or a result of parenting. We take a neuro-affirming view: we never try to make a child 'less autistic', we build on their strengths and gently help them cope with a world that isn't always built for them. Every autistic child is different, so support should be built around your child.

Signs you might recognise

- ✓ Communicates differently (delayed, limited, or advanced but literal)
- ✓ Finds deep comfort in routine, and distress when it changes
- ✓ Is sensitive to sounds, lights, textures or crowds
- ✓ Finds eye contact, turn-taking or social cues hard
- ✓ Has intense, focused interests they know everything about
- ✓ Feels and shows emotions very strongly

What you can do at home

- **Follow their lead.** Join their play and their interests on their terms. Connection comes before any teaching.
- **Make the day predictable.** Visual routines and a gentle warning before transitions ('two more minutes') lower anxiety a lot.
- **Honour sensory needs.** Notice what overwhelms your child and allow tools, headphones, fidgets, a quiet corner, without making it a battle.
- **Accept all communication.** Gestures, pictures, single words and devices all count. Being understood matters more than how.
- **Lower demands when they're dysregulated.** A child in overwhelm can't learn. Stay calm, reduce the pressure, and co-regulate first.

- **Build on their passions.** Deep interests are a bridge, not a distraction. Use them to grow language, learning and connection.

Presence over eye contact, connection over compliance. That's where progress starts.

When it's worth seeking support

Consider reaching out if, over time, you notice:

- › Communication, sensory or social needs affecting daily life
- › Frequent overwhelm or meltdowns that are hard to support
- › Big distress around change or transitions
- › You simply want guidance and someone in your corner

How The Lodestone Centre can help

We create a calm, predictable, sensory-aware space, then build communication, regulation and connection through your child's own strengths and interests, at their pace. We start by getting to know your child, then shape support around them.

Programs that often help: Say Play (Speech), SEL Program, Screening, Lodestone Evo, Progressive Coding.

Free 15-minute call · WhatsApp 012-212 7743 · thelodestonesolution.com

This guide is for general information and to support parents. The Lodestone Centre provides educational support, screening and programs; it is not a substitute for formal schooling or a clinical diagnosis. If you have concerns about your child's development, a screening or a chat with our team is a good next step.